

Dynamic architecture

While the British Post Office Tower (1964) featured the world's first revolving floor, the world's first fully rotating high-rise building is the 15-storey Suite Volland in Paraná, Brazil (opposite) opened in 2001, designed by Bruno de Franco. Each of the 11 floors is clad in double sheets of glass, tinted silver, gold or blue, which create spectacular effects as they rotate in opposite directions. Each floor can revolve 360 degrees in an hour. Following this concept, the Dynamic Tower (a.k.a. Da Vinci Tower) is a proposed 420-metre (1,378-ft), 80-floor skyscraper, designed by Italian-Israeli architect David Fisher (b.1949) for Dubai. As in the Suite Volland, each floor is intended to rotate independently, with one full rotation every 90 minutes, constantly changing the shape of the tower. The Dynamic Tower will be the world's first prefabricated skyscraper, with 90 per cent built off site in a factory; only the core of the tower will be built on site. Sourcing its power from onboard wind turbines and solar panels, it should produce enough surplus electricity to power five other similar-sized buildings in the area.

